

1. Offenbacher Seefestspiele (2017) Offenbach

1. OFFENBACHER SEEFESTSPIELE

INTERVENTION / PERFORMANCE, OFFENBACH, 2017

As the second part of the collaboration between YRD.Works and Künstlerhaus Mousonturm, the 1st Offenbach Lake Festival (Offenbacher Seefestspiele) took place in summer 2017 in the outdoor area of the Kressmann-Halle in Offenbach. The impulse for this work came from the artists' urban surroundings, largely characterised by vacant wasteland that has since entered into an unequal dialogue with the uniform new buildings of the harbour area. Similarities with conventional lake festivals such as those in Bregenz or Berlin are hard to find — and that is exactly what appealed to the collective. What might a lake festival look like in a city like Offenbach?

Much is in flux in the place where the artists live and work, and this in turn produces new ruptures. The starting point for the expansive sculpture in the outdoor area of the Kressmann-Halle was one such rupture — a construction fault that arose after a new adjacent road was built. Since then, during heavy rain, a pool of standing water collected on the grounds of the art space, which caught the artists' eye. YRD.Works made use of this defect and built a 600 m_2 concrete basin on the spot, which they flooded with 180,000 litres of water.

The artificial water surface served the 1st Offenbach Lake Festival as both stage and walk-in sculpture, staged with performative actions by contact Gonzo and Les Trucs during the festival. The ironic treatment of traditional cultural venues and the decontextualisation of their weighty ambience are at the centre of the action, as is the renegotiation of the cultural significance of such sites.

The collective's installation offers an experimental response to the format of the lake festival, whose traditional strategies and expectations are infiltrated and ultimately broken.



1. Offenbacher Seefestspiele (2017) Offenbach

1. OFFENBACHER SEEFESTSPIELE



1. Offenbacher Seefestspiele (2017) Offenbach





1. Offenbacher Seefestspiele (2017) Offenbach

1. OFFENBACHER SEEFESTSPIELE





1. Offenbacher Seefestspiele (2017) Offenbach

1. OFFENBACHER SEEFESTSPIELE



1. Offenbacher Seefestspiele (2017) Offenbach

1. OFFENBACHER SEEFESTSPIELE